

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 64 Summary

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In this lesson, Paul breaks down the Spanish verb *soler*, which means “to usually do something” or “used to do something,” depending on the tense. It’s a powerful and underused verb that allows learners to express habitual actions in both the present and past without having to conjugate multiple verbs. The video covers how to use *soler* with infinitives, conjugations in the present and imperfect tenses, and tips on when to include the subject pronoun for clarity.

Meaning of *Soler*:

Soler is used to express habitual actions—what someone “usually” or “used to” do.

Present Tense – “Usually Do”

Conjugation (present tense):

- yo suelo
- tú sueles
- él / ella / usted suele
- nosotros solemos
- vosotros soléis
- ellos / ellas / ustedes suelen

Examples:

- *Suelo fumar.* – I usually smoke.
 - *Mi hermano suele levantarse temprano.* – My brother usually gets up early.
 - *Solemos cocinar en casa.* – We usually cook at home.
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Imperfect Tense – “Used to Do”

Conjugation (imperfect tense):

- yo solía
- tú solías
- él / ella / usted solía

- nosotros solíamos
- vosotros solíais
- ellos / ellas / ustedes solían

Examples:

- *Solía leer todas las noches.* – I used to read every night.
 - *Juan solía tocar la guitarra.* – Juan used to play the guitar.
 - *Mis padres solían viajar mucho.* – My parents used to travel a lot.
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Why Use *Soler*?

It simplifies your Spanish by allowing you to plug in infinitives instead of conjugating a new verb every time.

Example:

- *Solía estudiar español.* – I used to study Spanish.
(Instead of conjugating *estudiar* in the imperfect.)
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Subject Clarity Tip:

In the present tense, you can often drop the subject pronoun:

- *Suelo fumar.* (It's clearly “yo.”)

In the imperfect, *solía* is used for multiple subjects, so include the subject if it's not clear:

- *Yo solía escuchar música.* – I used to listen to music.
 - *Juan solía escuchar música.* – Juan used to listen to music.
 - *Usted solía escuchar música.* – You used to listen to music.
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Conclusion:

Soler is a highly useful verb that helps Spanish learners express habits and past routines clearly and efficiently. Whether you're saying what you usually do or what you used to do, it allows you to form grammatically correct sentences with minimal conjugation effort. Just learn the forms of *soler* in the present and imperfect, and plug in infinitives to start building natural Spanish right away.